

WATERLOW PRESSURE ULCER RISK SCALE

Pressure Sore Risk Assessment and Prevention Strategy in Clinical Care

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Age / DOB: ____ / ____ / ____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

MRN / ID: _____

Date / Time: ____ / ____ / ____ : ____

PRESSURE ULCER RISK SUBSCALES

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
1. Build / Weight for Height BMI assessment	☐ Average BMI (0) (0) ☐ Above average BMI (1) (1) ☐ Obese / BMI > 30 (2) (2) ☐ Below average / Cachectic (3) (3)	[1]
2. Visual Skin Type High-risk areas	☐ Healthy intact skin (0) (0) ☐ Tissue paper / Dry / Oedematous (1) (1) ☐ Clammy / pyrexial skin (1) (1) ☐ Discolored / Stage 1 erythema (2) (2) ☐ Broken skin / Existing ulcer (3) (3)	[1]
3. Sex and Age Category Demographic risk weighting	☐ Male (1 pt) Female (2 pts) (1) ☐ 14-49 yrs (1 pt) 50-64 yrs (2 pts) (2) ☐ 65-74 yrs (3 pts) 75-80 yrs (4 pts) 81+ yrs (5 pts) (4)	[1]
4. Continence Sphincter control	☐ Complete continent / Catheterized (0) (0) ☐ Occasional incontinence (1) (1) ☐ Catheterized but incontinent of feces (2) (2) ☐ Doubly incontinent of urine and feces (3) (3)	[1]
5. Mobility Physical movement	☐ Fully mobile (0) (0) ☐ Restless / Fidgety (1) (1) ☐ Apathetic (2) (2) ☐ Restricted (3) (3) ☐ Bedbound (4) (4) ☐ Chairbound (5) (5)	[1]
6. Tissue Malnutrition Underlying systemic condition	☐ Terminal cachexia / Multi-organ failure (8) (8) ☐ Single major organ failure (5) (5) ☐ Peripheral vascular disease (5) (5) ☐ Severe anemia / Smoking (2) (2)	[1]
7. Neurological Deficit Sensory-motor impairment	☐ Diabetes / MS / Stroke / Paraplegia / Neuropathy (4-6 pts) (5)	[1]
8. Major Surgery / Trauma Orthopedic / spinal / OR table time	☐ Orthopaedic or spinal surgery below waist (5) (5) ☐ On operating table > 2 hours (5) (5)	[1]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: Score > 20 (High Risk)) **Assessor (RN / License #):** _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

At Risk (10 - 14 points)

Preventive foam mattress, q3h repositioning schedule, keep skin clean and moisturized.

High Risk (15 - 19 points)

Alternating pressure dynamic mattress, 30° tilt repositioning, heel elevation pads.

Very High Risk (≥ 20 points)

Specialized air-fluidized / dynamic replacement bed, q2h turning, dietitian review.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment